

Σωτάδης ὁ Μαρωνεὺς ὁ Ψευδής

Pseudo-Sotades and Fragments of Ethical Maxims

eul_aid: irk

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Ἰωνική [Ionic](#)

Domain: Ποίσις [Poetry](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Sotades of Maroneia, often called Pseudo-Sotades, was an iambic poet of the early 3rd century BCE. A native of Thrace, he was notorious for obscene and invective poetry during the reign of Ptolemy II Philadelphus. His mockery of the king's marriage to his sister Arsinoe II led to his execution, with ancient accounts claiming he was imprisoned in a leaden chest and drowned. The epithet "the liar" or "forger" may reflect later confusion with other poets.

No complete works of Sotades survive, only fragments. He is credited with perfecting the catalectic ionic dimeter named after him, the Sotadean meter, which became associated with scurrilous and satirical verse. His significance lies in formalizing this meter, which was adopted by later poets for subversive content. He represents the dangerous continuation of archaic iambic invective within the Hellenistic autocracies, and his fatal defiance made him a symbol of the risks of free speech. His name defined a genre of obscene poetry known as Sotadea.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ ἠθικῶν Γνωμῶν · [Fragments of Ethical Maxims](#) · 72 passages